DEVS CREATE 313

BUILDING WITH CLAUDE

Idea to First Version

A fill-in-the-blank workbook for tonight's workshop

What you will leave with

☐ An App Idea PDF and a Feedback Notes PDF that tests it

☐ A product spec PDF with your build broken into phases

☐ A WireFrame PDF and a clickable HTML prototype of your app

How to use this workbook

Each stage has starter prompts. Copy a prompt into Claude and replace anything in **[BRACKETS]** with your own details.

Work inside one project folder all night. What Claude gives you in one stage goes into the next, so save each output (App Idea, Feedback Notes, spec, WireFrame, prototype) to that folder.

Tonight's pacing

Time	Stage	Minutes
6:00	0. Set up project folder	5
6:05	1. Pick your idea	10
6:15	2. Validate your idea	10
6:25	3. Build spec plan	20
6:45	4. Build a wireframe	20
7:05	5. Build a clickable demo	40
7:45	Share-out	15

Stage 0: Set up your project folder (5 minutes)

Make a project folder in Claude Code (terminal) or create a Claude Project in the browser if you are on a free plan. Every file you make tonight goes there. If you are in the browser, download each PDF Claude makes and add it to your Project's files so the next stage can read it.

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STAGE 1 | ABOUT 10 MINUTES

Pick Your Idea

Turn a rough idea into five concepts, then choose one and save it.

Prompts

STEP 1: IF YOU NEED AN IDEA

My idea: **[YOUR IDEA]**.
Generate 5 distinct app concepts based on my idea. Write each one in exactly this format:
"An app that **[helps/provides a way]** for **[Persona]** who want(s) to **[needs/goals/struggles]** by **[user story/feature]** and **[user story/feature]**.

STEP 1B: IF YOU LIKE THE IDEA

Let's go with **[insert idea]** and save it into the project as a PDF called **[Name the PDF]**.
This document should have a header APP Idea and bold it.

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STAGE 2 | ABOUT 10 MINUTES

Validate Your Idea

Find the weaknesses before you spend time building.

STEP 2: VALIDATE YOUR IDEA (SAVE THE OUTPUT AS YOUR FEEDBACK PDF)

You are reviewing an early-stage app idea. Your job is to find the weaknesses before the person spends time building it. Do not praise the idea, do not soften criticism, and do not encourage them to "go for it."

IDEA: **[YOUR IDEA, OR THE CONCEPT YOU PICKED IN STAGE 1]**

Work through these in order:
1. Restate the idea in one sentence: who it is for, what problem it solves, and what the app does. If the idea doesn't specify any of these, say which is missing and state the assumption you're making to continue.
2. Problem check. Is this a problem people have and feel, or one the author thinks they should have? What do people do about it today (other apps, spreadsheets, a trainer, nothing)? If the current workaround is "nothing," explain whether that signals an opportunity or a lack of demand.
3. Competition. Name specific existing apps or products that already do this or most of it. Search if you can. For each, state what the idea would do differently. If the difference is a feature a competitor could add in a week, say so.
4. Target user. Identify the narrowest group who would want this most. If the idea targets "everyone," explain why that will fail and propose one specific starting audience.
5. Logic gaps. Quote the exact phrases in the idea that rest on unstated assumptions or vague terms (e.g., "overall health," "ensure," "neglected") and explain what each would need to mean for the app to work.
6. Retention and behavior. Why would someone open this on day 30? What has to be true about user behavior (logging, honesty, consistency) for the core feature to function?
7. Feasibility. Flag anything that is harder to build than it sounds, and any data the app depends on that it may not be able to get.
8. Riskiest assumption. Name the single assumption that, if wrong, kills the idea. Describe the cheapest test to check it in under two weeks, without writing code.
9. Verdict: Build / Rework / Drop, with two or three sentences of reasoning.
Rules:
- Be specific. "The market is crowded" is not acceptable; name the apps.
- If a strength exists, mention it only where it affects the verdict.
- Do not invent statistics. If you're unsure, say so.
- Keep the whole response under 600 words.

STEP 2B: SAVE INTO PROJECT

Save this into the project and call it "Feedback Notes" and give it the header "Feedback".

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STAGE 3 | ABOUT 20 MINUTES

Build Spec Plan

Claude interviews you, then writes a spec PDF your build agent will follow.

Prompt

STEP 3: BUILD SPEC PLAN

I have an idea for a digital product: **[ONE-SENTENCE PITCH FROM STAGE 1]**.
Help me turn this into a PDF product spec I can later hand to AI coding agents. Break work into phases or sprints. Have the AI build one phase carefully, then commit before moving on.

Step 1 - Interview me with the AskUserQuestion tool.
- Ask in two rounds of 3-4 multiple-choice questions each.
- Round 1: the big product decisions (platform, how users input data, how goals/targets work, business model).
- Round 2: based on my Round 1 answers, ask about my coding experience, level of detail/scope for v1, and the most important user interaction.
- Mark a recommended option when there's a sensible default.
- Don't write anything until both rounds are answered.

Step 2 - Write a spec doc in PDF format (not a chat reply) with these sections:
1. App idea - one-paragraph pitch, the problem it solves, and the core user loop.
2. Product decisions - a table: Question | My decision | What it means for the build.
3. Functional spec - key screens and features, the core logic/rules, a simple data model, and a free vs. paid feature table if relevant.
4. Recommended build phases - 6-8 small phases, each ending in something I can run. For each phase write an "Agent task" paragraph I can paste to an AI agent, plus a checklist of acceptance criteria. Include a simple roadmap diagram of the phases.
5. Working with agents - how to use this spec with agents, constraints for every phase, and what's out of scope for v1.

Keep the tech stack beginner-friendly if I say I'm new to coding, and stick to the decisions I made in the interview.

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STAGE 4 | ABOUT 20 MINUTES

Build a Wireframe

Compare three user flows from your spec, then pick one on purpose.

Prompts

STEP 4: BUILD A WIREFRAME

```
Create 3 different medium-fidelity wireframe user flows for my project so I can compare
layouts. My project: [REVIEW THE BUILD SPEC PDF]
```

STEP 4B: PICK YOUR FLOW

```
Go with [CHOOSE FLOW] and make it into a PDF called WireFrame.
```

STAGE 5 | ABOUT 40 MINUTES

Build a Clickable Demo

Turn the wireframe you picked into a prototype you can tap through.

Prompt

STEP 5: BUILD A CLICKABLE DEMO (ATTACH YOUR WIREFRAME PDF)

```
Build a clickable HTML prototype from this wireframe. Match the layout exactly. Link every
button and nav item to its screen. Use placeholder content. Single file.
```

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FINISHED EARLY?

Stretch Goals

- ☐ Determine monetization strategies
- ☐ Determine marketing strategies
- ☐ Determine any loading states or animations

Tips that apply to every stage

- ☐ Be specific. "A sign-up sheet for my church's food pantry volunteers" gets a better answer than "a volunteer app."
- ☐ Ask for one thing at a time. Big requests produce big, hard-to-fix results.
- ☐ When an answer is confusing, say so and ask Claude to explain it more simply.
- ☐ Paste exact error messages and screenshots instead of describing them.
- ☐ Claude can be wrong. If something doesn't work, it isn't your fault. Report what happened and try the fix.